reviews would have been made transparent, thus raising accountability and transparency based on team spirit, and *research by academics and the publication of their findings would have been encouraged.

Such sessions/workshops would provide useful feedback to the seniors. And after summations have been presented and the acquired knowledge disseminated, police personnel at all levels would gain by the collective wisdom, without any exceptions. A sense of total commitment to the service would then be instilled in one and all.

All this to me would constitute the real Gandhian way of policing.

When everything would be based on collective wisdom, integrity and a spirit of national service: *How could there be discrimination on any basis? *How could there be one set of rules for the rich and powerful and another for the weak and the marginalized? *Would not all be equal before the law? *Would not law prevail rather than position? *How could there persist negative interference of any kind from any quarter?

With enhanced respect for law would there be not greater compliance with, and respect for, rules and regulations? Would not such a development: *Enhance the feeling of security? *Bring people closer to the police? *Strengthen intelligence? *Prevent crimes? *Improve detection of crimes to a great extent? *Usher in truthful policing?

Would we not call this the Gandhian model? Such a model would be: *simple, *transparent, *fair, *fearless, *participatory, *truthful, *non-discriminatory and *compassionate, yet non-sparing for the saboteur.

When such a model would have been put in place, positive developments would have followed. For instance: *Openness would have developed between the police and the people, leading to mutual trust. *Open sharing of any inadequacies or deficiencies among the cops would have kept them on their toes so that their previous mistakes are not repeated. *There would be nothing to hide and nothing to be defensive about. *People could be equal stakeholders in their security and welfare. *Certain citizens could be identified and entrusted with special responsibilities to resolve matters, which have the potential to breach the peace in society. *Wherever possible, women, students, senior citizens and other volunteers could be coopted to enlarge the resource base.

Given such a state of affairs, one may well ask: *Where would be the scope left for corruption and related evils to continue? *Who would/could harbour terrorists, because both the police and the citizens would have become vigilant? *Why would citizens not report suspicious persons or objects? *Why would not women fearlessly report violence against them? *Why would anyone remain a silent victim of any form of injustice? *Why would false arrests or arrests under pressure be made? *Why would not complaints be registered and follow-up action taken by the police without favouritism, irrespective of the status of the complainant? (Presently, the complaints of the poorer sections of society are treated with apathy.) *Why would not the latest technology (such as state-of-the-art video equipment) be used everywhere to record events (wherever possible) and also the statements of witnesses to the police so that they cannot retract them later and turn hostile? (As per the present law, confessions before the police are not admissible in a court of law.)

Civil society too could lend a helping hand in sponsoring the required hardware in case government funds were not immediately available or had been used up. Even corporates could be roped in because they would stand to benefit greatly if crime levels were reduced. Such funding could be part of their social responsibility.

All these aspects are Gandhian for me. And are possible. I am not being unduly idealistic; participative leadership and unflinching determination can achieve the aforementioned objectives.